

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Is it an honest company?



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about people's interests and backgrounds using a wider range of language.

Ask your partner:

- What do you think the term "probing question" means?
- What are some strategies to deal with hostile questions?

Can Do Statements

- I can ask probing questions.
- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can deal with challenging and hostile questions.





Let's Explore!

Miranda is interviewed by a reporter. What a **distressing*** situation!

* "Distressing" means worrying/terrible.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Reporter:** Representing Polygon, successful promoter of Holly's Wear, Miranda Morehouse! Miranda, would you give us an overview of this situation if there is any chance to make things clear?
- Miranda:** Certainly. We are in a distressing situation since we recently discovered that we were deceived and made complicit in human rights abuses.
- Reporter:** Offshore child labor, right?
- Miranda:** Yes. I'd be happy to answer questions after I present the story. May I proceed?
- Reporter:** Go ahead.
- Miranda:** We were terribly distressed to learn that Holly's outsources its labor at a production plant that employs children. Now this is common and legal in Tindasia, but we have a strong ethical stand against child labor.
- Reporter:** If you have a strong ethical stand how can you support this company?
- Miranda:** Please let me explain. We are ethical so we support Holly's commitment to change. Farmani was unaware that children work at his factory. He was shocked and outraged at the discovery.
- Reporter:** If you didn't know what was happening, then how could you inform Farmani? I'm confused.
- Miranda:** It would be clearer if I could explain without interruption. We found a rumor over social media and immediately followed up with an investigation. We wanted to know the truth.
- Reporter:** If you wanted facts, why would you go to social media?
- Miranda:** Please hear me: you and I both respect the public. We found the real facts with a private investigator. What I want to emphasize is that we were shocked and distressed. Change will happen immediately.
- Reporter:** That was Miranda Morehouse, shocked and distressed and about to change Tindasian society. Meanwhile, plenty of Tindasian adults remain for Holly's to exploit. Goodnight everyone!



Let's Practice!

Can you bring me up to speed*?

* To "bring up to speed" means to provide the most current information.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Check the mistakes and correct the sentences. There are two mistakes in each sentence. Read them aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Miranda, would to you give us an overview of this situation, if there is any chances to make things clear?
2. If you has a strong ethical standard, how can you supporting this company?
3. If you didn't know what was happened, then how could you informing Farmani?
4. If you wants facts, why should you going to social media?



Let's Practice!

What words can we use in an interview?

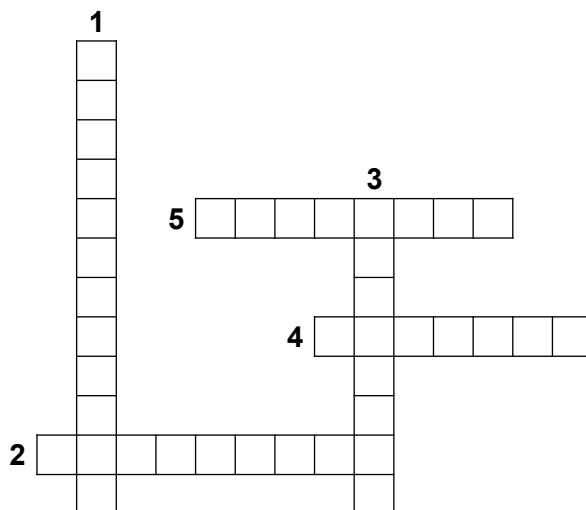
Instructions: Read the phrases. Complete the crossword with words relate to work.

Down

1. stopping someone's speech by saying something; something that breaks the flow.
3. a short summary of the main points.

Across

2. to cause someone to think differently than the truth
4. to move forward
5. to do something that builds on or adds to a previous action





Extension Activity

Ask some probing questions!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of a situation that you know something about but don't have enough information on to really understand the truth.
- Create probing questions using "if ... then ..."
- Once you have a list of 4-5 questions, exchange your list with your partner.
- Answer the questions by acknowledging them politely and providing necessary information.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I ask probing questions about an issue.

☐ ☐

My partner and I exchange our ideas.

☐ ☐

I answer probing questions politely and in detail.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- overview** (noun): a short summary of the main points
e.g. Miranda, would you give us an overview of this situation?
- private investigator** (noun): someone hired by a company or individual to find out secret information
e.g. We found the real facts with a private investigator.
- ethical stand** (expression): to make a strong public decision about what is right or wrong and act according to that decision
e.g. Now this is common and legal in Tindasia, but we have a strong ethical stand against child labor.
- interruption** (noun): stopping someone's speech by saying something; something that breaks the flow
e.g. It would be clearer if I could explain without interruption.
- follow up** (verb): to do something that builds on or adds to a previous action
e.g. We found a rumor over social media and immediately followed up with an investigation.
- to proceed** (verb): to move forward
e.g. May I proceed?





Learning Points

Using the Conditional 'if-then' Construction in Questions

Probing questions try to get at deep understandings of an issue. The conditional construction can be useful for this. When one fact depends on another fact to be true, then we use the 'if-then' construction.

We may be told something that we are not sure that we believe because of something else we have heard or experienced. We may express each idea in a clause, making one dependent on the other. You know one thing is true, so the other one is false unless someone has some information that is not obvious.

Example: Something you heard doesn't seem to make sense because of something you observed. Is what you heard wrong, or is there more information that is missing?

1. *You have heard that your colleague is quitting his job.*
2. *You observe your colleague put more money on his cafeteria lunch card, as if he were staying longer.*

Probing Question: If he is quitting his job, then why did he put more money on his cafeteria lunch card?

There are two sides to your question. One is asked, but the second, unasked question, is what you really want to know most.

1. Asked: *Why did he put money on his card?*
2. Unasked: *Is he really quitting?* Maybe he isn't!

Most likely it is NOT true that your colleague is quitting. But there may be information you don't know about. For instance, perhaps he is going to gift his meal card to another colleague when he leaves.





Learning Points

Statement you don't know if you believe	Something you do know	Probing question
There is a real Santa Claus who gives gifts to all children in one night.	Gifts for all the children in the world couldn't all fit in Santa's sleigh.	<u>If</u> Santa Claus gives gifts to all the children in the world on one night, <u>then how</u> do they all fit in his sleigh?
Our manager is doing a fantastic job.	Many good employees are leaving.	<u>If</u> our manager is doing a fantastic job, <u>then why</u> are so many good employees leaving?
My husband said he bought me flowers.	My husband walked home and he is not carrying flowers.	<u>If</u> he bought me flowers but isn't carrying them, <u>then where</u> did he put them?

Often in spoken English, we leave out the word "then". It is understood without being said.

*The clauses of these questions can be turned around. Just remember that the indefinite pronouns should be replaced by the specific nouns in the first clause.

Examples:

- *If Santa Claus gives gifts to all the children in the world on one night, how do they all fit in his sleigh?*
- *If our manager is doing a fantastic job, why are so many good employees leaving?*
- *If he bought me flowers but isn't carrying them, where did he put them?*
- *How do all the gifts fit in Santa Claus's sleigh, if he gives them to all the children in the world on one night?*
- *Why are so many good employees leaving, if our manager is doing a fantastic job?*
- *Where did he put the flowers, if he bought me some?*





Learning Points

Dealing with Challenging and Hostile Questions

There are times when you may be asked questions which are hostile or difficult to answer. Using polite, honest answers helps keep everyone calm even when the questioner wishes to raise emotions.

Sometimes questions are not meant as questions at all - they could be intended to make you look unprepared, to confuse you, or give a negative message to you and other listeners. One approach to answering hostile questions is to ask for a chance to explain. This gives you a chance to gather your thoughts and prevent the other person from interrupting you before you get to provide a thoughtful answer.

Examples:

May I explain?

May I proceed without interruption?

May I continue?

Please allow me to explain.

Will you allow me to go on?

Another important tip is to acknowledge the person's question, no matter how rude or uncomfortable the question. Then continue to say what you really feel is important to communicate.

Examples:

• Hostile question: *If you are an honest company, how can you buy products from that horrible business?*

Response: *We are honest (acknowledgment) and we will encourage that company to change its practices if they want our business (your main point).*

• Hostile question: *You didn't care to recycle for ten years, right?*

Response: *We did not recycle for a long time (acknowledgment of question) and are happy to announce that we have learned to do differently (your main point).*

• Hostile question: *Why don't you give your employees job security with long-term contracts?*

Response: *We are not giving out long-term contracts (acknowledgment) until we know whether or not we will be successful enough in this area to give people job security (your main point).*

